

C. Luke Watson

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Research Interests

Public Economics, Urban Economics, Industrial Organization
Tax Incidence, Imperfect Information, Bank Branching, Online Bank Competition

Employment

Senior Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC	Aug 2023
Financial Economist, Center for Financial Research, FDIC	Aug 2021 - Aug 2023

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Michigan State University	2015 - 2021
M.A. Economics, Old Dominion University	2013 - 2015
B.A. Economics, Old Dominion University	2009 - 2013

Publications

“A Test for Pricing Power in Urban Housing Markets” (with O.Ziv)	2025
– Accepted, Review of Economics and Statistics	

Working Papers

“Is the Rent Too High: Land Ownership and Monopoly Power” (with O.Ziv)	2025
– R&R, Real Estate Economics	

Works in Progress

“Bank Competition for Neighborhood Deposits” (with M.Kutzbach, G.Wagner)
“Algorithmic Pricing in Residential Rental Markets” (with N.Eubanks, A.Handler, O.Ziv)
“Estimating Markups using Pass-Through Regressions” (with O.Ziv)
“Distance and Deposits” (with F. Toyin-Elebuta)
“Testing for Uniform Pricing Using Deposit Account Data” (with T.Kravitz, F. Toyin-Elebuta)
“Bank Website Adoption and Implications” (with L.Baldomero-Quintana, N.Rowe, A.Ufier)
“Learning about Banks using a Bank Activity Index” (with J.Kachovic, J.Pandolfo)
“Bank Entry in Concentrated Markets” (with C. Levy)
“A Test for Market Definition in Aggregate Logit Models with an Application to Retail Banking”
“CBDC News and Market Sentiment” (with S.Borkhoche, J.Yung)
– Currently paused due to EO 14178

Prior Employment

Instructor : Development Economics (Michigan State University)	Fall 2020
Instructor : Principles of Microeconomics (Old Dominion University)	Summer 2015
TA : (MSU) Public Revenues, Ec. of Poverty & Income, Int'l Trade (x4), Urban Econ (x3)	
Interm.Micro, Intro.Micro, Intro.Macro	2015-2020
TA : (AEASP) Foundations Microeconomics and Mathematics	Summer 2017
RA : (MSU) Oren Ziv, Prabhat Barnwal, (ODU) Gary Wagner, Tim Komarek	2013-2020
Barista : Starbucks	2009-2015

Presentations

2025: Richmond Fed, AREUEA Nat'l, NYC DOF.
 2024: Lincoln Institute UE & PE Conference. 2023: Mid-Atlantic Trade Workshop, NTA.
 2022: AREUEA / ASSA, AREUEA Nat'l, NTA, UEA (USA). 2021: UEA (Europe).
 2020: Ohio University, MVEA, NTA. 2019: NTA.

FDIC Projects

Deposit Study: GFC Runs [Internal, In-progress]	2025
Deposit Study: Deposit Stability [Internal, In-progress]	2025
Options for Deposit Insurance Reform [Public]	2023
Literature Review on Digital Currencies and Financial Stability [Internal]	2022
Crypto-Watch Paper Round-Up [Internal]	2022-2025

Dissertation Work on EITC

"The General Equilibrium Incidence of the Earned Income Tax Credit"	2021
"Estimating Supply & Demand Elasticities Using a Single Tax Rate with GE Spillovers"	2021
"The Local Labor Market Effects of State EITC Supplements"	2021

Service

AEASP-FDIC - Experiential Learning Partner	Summer 2024
FDIC - History of the FDIC presenter	2024-2025
FDIC - CFR Seminar Coordinator	2022-2024
FDIC - Reader for FDIC Consumer Research Symposium	2022-2023
Michigan State University - Applied Economics Student Workshop Organizer	2017-2020
Michigan State University - Graduate Student Seminar Organizer	2018-2020
Michigan State University - Graduate Instruction Committee	2017-2018
Old Dominion University - Ad Hoc Committee on Birthday Singing	2013-2015

Referee Service

Contemporary Economic Policy, International Tax and Public Finance, Journal of Financial Services Research, Journal of Real Estate Finance and Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, Public Finance Review

Awards and Grants

Star Award (FDIC)	2024
Mission Achievement Award (FDIC)	2023
Dissertation Completion Fellowship (MSU)	2020
Outstanding Graduate Economics Student Award (ODU)	2015
Graduate Student Tuition Fellowship (ODU)	2013-2015
Constant Dominion Business Student Merit Scholarship (ODU)	2013
Town-N-Gown Scholarship (ODU)	2013
Governor's Technology Tuition Scholarship (ODU)	2009-2013
Time Magazine Person of the Year (shared)	2006

Memberships

American Economics Association, American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association, National Tax Association